Notes version: 06 Nov 08:14 IST (if this time is old, reload the page)

HISTORY · Emergence of Buddhism and Jainism (6th century BCE)

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? Around 600–500 BCE two new religious movements, **Buddhism** (Gautama Buddha) and **Jainism** (Mahavira), arose in the Ganga plains (Magadha, Kosala, Vajji). They rejected costly Vedic sacrifices and the birth-based caste order and taught a simple path of right conduct. **Why did they arise now?** Because politics, society, economy and religion had all changed (table below). Because it is asked every year, learn it in the **Politics · Society · Economy · Religion** order.

1. Why did new religions arise? (Politics · Society · Economy · Religion)

Area	What was happening	Effect
Politics	Tribes had grown into **16 Mahajanapadas**; Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa and Avanti were the strongest. Kings and the warrior (Kshatriya) class gained power.	Kshatriyas (Buddha and Mahavira were both Kshatriya princes) resented the Brahmins' top place and backed new teachers.
Society	The four-varna order had become hereditary and rigid; Shudras and women were low, with no right to study the Vedas.	Common people liked teachers who said that a person is great by conduct, not by birth.
Economy	**Iron** ploughs spread farming; cattle were needed for ploughing but sacrifices killed many; towns, trade and **punch-marked coins** raised the importance of merchants (Vaishyas), who had low rank in the varna order.	Merchants and farmers supported non-violent religions that gave them respect (Anathapindika, a banker, gave a monastery to the Buddha).
Religion	Vedic religion had become costly, ritual-heavy and in Sanskrit, controlled by priests. The Upanishads already asked deeper questions.	People wanted a simple, cheap, local-language path to salvation.

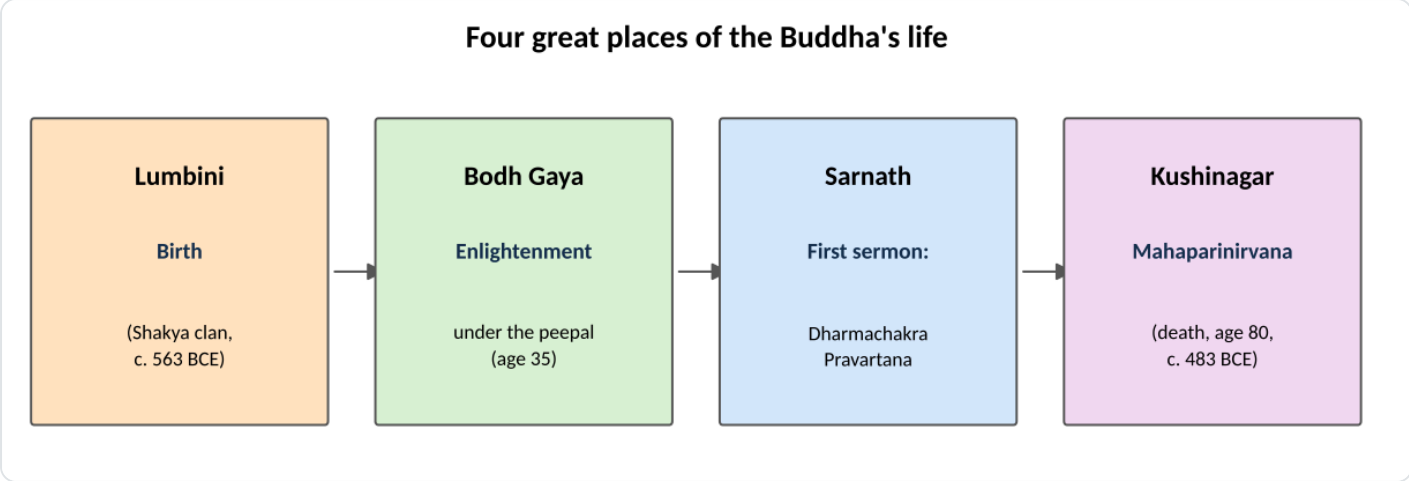
The 16 Mahajanapadas (learn the names once)

Mahajanapada	Capital	Mahajanapada	Capital
Anga	Champa	Magadha	Rajagriha (later Pataliputra)
Kashi	Varanasi	Kosala	Shravasti (Ayodhya)
Vajji (Vrijji)	Vaishali	Malla	Kushinagar, Pava
Chedi	Shuktimati	Vatsa	Kaushambi
Kuru	Indraprastha	Panchala	Ahichchhatra, Kampilya
Machchha (Matsya)	Viratanagara	Surasena	Mathura

Assaka (Ashmaka)	**Potana/Podana (on the Godavari)**	Avanti	Ujjain, Mahishmati
Gandhara	Taxila	Kamboja	Rajapura

Only **Assaka** lay in the south (on the Godavari), which makes it important for AP. Vajji and Malla were **republics (gana-sanghas)**, the others were monarchies. **Magadha** finally won (more on Day 4).

2. Buddhism



Four great places of the Buddha's life

- **Life:** Siddhartha Gautama, a prince of the **Shakya** clan, born in **Lumbini** (Nepal) about 563 BCE; father **Suddhodana**, mother **Mayadevi** (died soon after; raised by **Mahaprajapati Gautami**). Wife **Yashodhara**, son **Rahula**.
- **Four sights** (an old man, a sick man, a dead body, a monk) made him ask why people suffer. At 29 he left home: the **Great Renunciation (Mahabhinishkramana)**, with his charioteer **Channa** and horse **Kanthaka**. He learnt from **Alara Kalama** and **Uddaka Ramaputta** but was not satisfied.
- **Enlightenment (Nirvana/Bodhi):** at 35 at **Bodh Gaya** (Uruvela, on the Niranjana river) under a peepal tree, becoming the 'Buddha' (the awakened one). **First sermon** at **Sarnath** (deer park, Isipatana) to five disciples: **Dharmachakra Pravartana**. **Death (Mahaparinirvana)** at **Kushinagar** about 483 BCE, aged 80.

Teachings in simple words

Idea	Meaning	Example
Four Noble Truths	1. Life has suffering (dukkha). 2. Suffering is caused by desire (trishna). 3. Ending desire ends suffering (nirvana). 4. The way is the Eightfold Path.	Like a doctor: the illness, its cause, the cure possible, the medicine.
Eightfold Path (Ashtangika Marga)	Right view, resolve, speech, action, livelihood, effort, mindfulness, concentration.	Three groups: wisdom, conduct, mind-training.
Middle Path	Avoid both luxury and harsh self-torture.	Like a veena string: neither too tight nor too loose.

Core ideas	Everything changes (anicca), no permanent soul (anatta), karma and rebirth, **no creator God discussed**, **non-violence**. Five precepts (Panchasheela): no killing, stealing, lying, intoxicants, sexual misconduct.	

Organisation, canon and councils

- **Sangha** (order of monks, **bhikshus**; nuns allowed later, first **Mahaprajapati Gautami**) and lay followers (**upasakas**). Language: **Pali** (the people's language). Scriptures: **Tripitaka** (Vinaya = monastic rules, Sutta = sermons, Abhidhamma = philosophy). Symbols: lotus (birth), horse (renunciation), peepal (enlightenment), wheel (first sermon), stupa (death).
- **Patrons:** Bimbisara, Ajatashatru (Magadha), Prasenajit (Kosala), later **Ashoka, Kanishka, Harsha**.

Council	Place	Ruler	President / result
1st (c. 483 BCE)	Rajagriha	Ajatashatru	Mahakassapa; Sutta and Vinaya compiled
2nd (c. 383 BCE)	Vaishali	Kalashoka	Sabakami; split into Sthaviravadins and Mahasanghikas
3rd (c. 250 BCE)	Pataliputra	Ashoka	Moggaliputta Tissa; Abhidhamma completed; missions sent abroad
4th (c. 72 CE)	Kundalavana, Kashmir	Kanishka	Vasumitra (with Ashvaghosha); split into **Hinayana** and **Mahayana**

Hinayana (Theravada): follows the original teaching, Buddha as teacher, Pali, personal nirvana (Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Thailand). **Mahayana:** Buddha worshipped as god in images, Sanskrit, bodhisattvas (China, Japan, Korea). **Vajrayana:** tantric form (Tibet).

EXAMPLE

Andhra link (all regions equal): the Buddhist sites of AP are exam favourites: **Amaravati** (Guntur; Satavahana period, great stupa), **Nagarjunakonda** (Ikshvaku period), **Salihundam** (Srikakulam), **Bavikonda** and **Thotlakonda** (Visakhapatnam). **Acharya Nagarjuna** (Madhyamika school, Shunyavada) is linked with Andhra.

3. Jainism

- Jains believe in **24 Tirthankaras** ('ford-makers' who show the way across the cycle of rebirth). The 1st is **Rishabhanatha (Adinatha)**, the 23rd **Parshvanatha** (of Varanasi; **four vows**: non-violence, truth, non-stealing, non-possession), the 24th **Mahavira**, who **added the fifth vow: celibacy (brahmacharya)**.
- **Mahavira (Vardhamana):** born about 599 BCE at **Kundagrama near Vaishali** in the **Jnatrika** clan; father **Siddhartha**, mother **Trishala** (a Lichchhavi princess); wife **Yashoda**. Left home at **30**, 12 years of penance, attained **Kaivalya** (perfect knowledge) at **Jrimbhikagrama on the Rijupalika river** under a sal tree, hence **Jina** (conqueror) and 'Jainism'. Died at **Pavapuri** (near Rajagriha) about 527 BCE, aged 72.

Idea	Meaning
Triratna (three jewels)	Right faith, right knowledge, right conduct: the path to **moksha**.
Five vows (Mahavratas)	Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Aparigraha, Brahmacharya. Ahimsa is extreme: even insects are protected.
Core ideas	Every living thing and even objects have a **soul (jiva)**; karma sticks to the soul; **no creator God**; **Anekantavada** (truth has many sides) and **Syadvada** ('maybe', perhaps).
Sects	**Digambara** (sky-clad, no clothes; led by **Bhadrabahu**, who went south with Chandragupta Maurya, to Shravanabelagola) and **Svetambara** (white-clad; led by **Sthulabhadra**, Magadha).
Canon and language	**Prakrit (Ardhamagadhi)**; scriptures **12 Angas**, compiled in the **Council of Pataliputra** (c. 300 BCE, Sthulabhadra) and finalised at the **Council of Valabhi** (c. 512 CE, Devardhi Kshamashramana).
Patrons and places	Bimbisara, Ajatashatru, Chandragupta Maurya, **Kharavela** of Kalinga (Hathigumpha inscription); Gangas of Karnataka (**Gomateshwara/Bahubali statue**, Shravanabelagola, built by Chamundaraya); Dilwara temples, Mount Abu.

4. Buddhism vs Jainism

Point	Buddhism	Jainism
Founder	Gautama Buddha	Mahavira (24th Tirthankara)
Path	Middle path (no extremes)	Severe penance, fasting (even to death: sallekhana)
Soul	No permanent soul (anatta)	Soul exists in all living things (jiva)
Ahimsa	Important but moderate	Strictest, central
Goal	Nirvana	Moksha/Kaivalya
Language	Pali	Prakrit
Spread	Spread widely abroad (Ashoka's missions)	Stayed mainly in India (west, south)

EXAM TRAP

Both were **Kshatriya** reformers of **Magadha region** and both rejected Vedic authority and animal sacrifice. Buddha died at **Kushinagar**, Mahavira at **Pavapuri**. Buddha's first sermon: **Sarnath**; his enlightenment: **Bodh Gaya**. Mahavira added the **fifth** vow (Parshvanatha preached four). The Buddhist canon is the **Tripitaka (Pali)**, the Jain canon the **12 Angas (Prakrit)**. **Hinayana/Mahayana split: 4th Council, Kanishka.** Buddha's symbol of birth: lotus; Mahavira's: lion.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about Buddhism:

1. Gautama Buddha delivered his first sermon at Sarnath.

2. The Third Buddhist Council was held at Pataliputra under Ashoka.

3. The Tripitakas were originally written in Sanskrit.

4. The Fourth Council under Kanishka led to the Hinayana–Mahayana division.

Which of the above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 4 only

B. 1, 3 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. The Tripitakas were written in Pali, so statement 3 is wrong.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (Buddhist Council) with List-II (place and ruler):

List-I (Buddhist Council)	List-II (place and ruler)
A. First	**1.** Kundalavana (Kashmir), Kanishka
B. Second	**2.** Pataliputra, Ashoka
C. Third	**3.** Vaishali, Kalashoka
D. Fourth	**4.** Rajagriha, Ajatashatru

(1) A → 4 B → 3 C → 2 D → 1

(2) A → 3 B → 4 C → 2 D → 1

(3) A → 4 B → 3 C → 1 D → 2

(4) A → 2 B → 3 C → 4 D → 1

Answer: (1) First: Rajagriha; Second: Vaishali; Third: Pataliputra; Fourth: Kundalavana.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements about Jainism is NOT correct?

A. Mahavira attained Kaivalya on the banks of the Rijupalika river.

B. Parshvanatha, the 23rd Tirthankara, preached four vows.

C. Jainism accepts God as the creator of the universe.

D. The Jain canon was finalised at the Council of Valabhi.

Answer: C. Jainism does not accept a creator God; the universe is eternal and runs by karma.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): Buddhism spread quickly among traders and common people in the 6th century BCE. Reason (R): It used Pali, the language of the people, and did not give importance to birth-based varna. Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: A. The people's language and equality of birth attracted common folk and merchants.

PRACTICE

Two travellers describe the same elephant differently after touching different parts, and a teacher says each description is partly true. This idea most closely reflects which doctrine?

A. Anekantavada of Jainism

B. Anatta of Buddhism

C. Middle Path of Buddhism

D. Pashupata of Shaivism

Answer: A. Anekantavada says truth has many sides; Syadvada states each view as 'perhaps'.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write the table of the four reasons (politics, society, economy, religion) for the rise of new religions. 2. List the four Noble Truths and Jain five vows. 3. Write the four Buddhist councils with place and ruler.

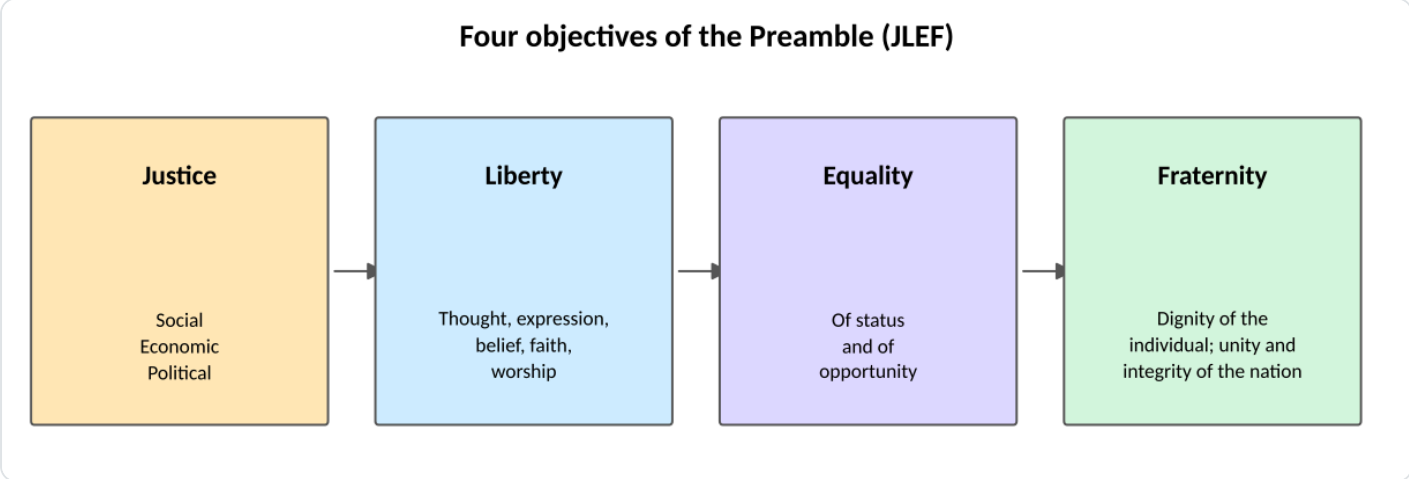
POLITY · The Preamble

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? The Preamble is the short introduction at the start of the Constitution. It tells **who** made it (the people), **what kind** of state we are building (sovereign, socialist, secular, democratic republic) and **why** (justice, liberty, equality, fraternity). It comes from the **Objectives Resolution** moved by Nehru (Day 1). Think of it as the Constitution's **identity card**.

1. The words, one by one

Word	Meaning	Example / note
We, the people of India	Final authority is the people; the Constitution is not a gift of any king or foreign power.	Adopted on **26 Nov 1949**.
Sovereign	India is free from any outside control and decides its internal and foreign affairs.	Yet India stays in the Commonwealth or UN willingly.
Socialist (**42nd Amend. 1976**)	**Democratic socialism**: the State works to reduce inequality, with a **mixed economy** (public and private).	Not Soviet-type nationalisation of everything.
Secular (**42nd Amend. 1976**)	The State has **no official religion** and treats all faiths equally; every person is free to follow any religion.	Arts 25–28 give the freedom of religion.
Democratic	Power comes from the people through elections (political, social and economic democracy).	Universal adult franchise.
Republic	The head of State (President) is **elected**, not hereditary.	UK is a monarchy; India is a republic.



Four objectives of the Preamble (JLEF)

Memory: J-L-E-F = Justice, Liberty, Equality, Fraternity. The words **'unity and integrity of the nation'** in Fraternity were added by the **42nd Amendment**. Justice was inspired by the **Russian Revolution**; Liberty, Equality and Fraternity by the **French Revolution** (Ireland and USSR ideas also).

2. Is the Preamble part of the Constitution? (cases)

Case	Decision
Berubari Union case (1960)	Preamble is **not** part of the Constitution; it is a key to the mind of the makers.
Kesavananda Bharati (1973)	Overruled it: Preamble **is** part of the Constitution; it can be amended but the **basic structure** cannot be destroyed.
LIC of India case (1995)	Reaffirmed that the Preamble is an integral part.

- **Amended only once:** by the **42nd Amendment (1976)**, which added 'Socialist', 'Secular' and 'Integrity'.
- The Preamble is **not enforceable** in a court, is **not a source of power** to the legislature and **not a limit** on its powers. It helps to **interpret** doubtful provisions.
- Praise for the Preamble: **K.M. Munshi** called it the 'political horoscope' of the Constitution; **Ernest Barker** the 'key-note'; **Thakur Das Bhargava** the 'soul'.

EXAMPLE

Example: if a State declared one religion as the 'official religion' and made its rituals compulsory in government schools, it would violate the Preamble's **Secular** idea (and Arts 25–28). If a law gave an advantage only to people of one caste in public jobs without reason, it would violate **Equality of status and opportunity**.

EXAM TRAP

Preamble amended **once (1976)**. **Berubari: not part; Kesavananda: part**. Words added in 1976: **Socialist, Secular, Integrity**. Republic = **elected head**. Preamble is **non-justiciable**. 'We, the people' = **sovereignty of the people**. The date in the Preamble is **26 Nov 1949**, not 26 Jan 1950.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about the Preamble:
1. In the Berubari Union case (1960) the Supreme Court held that the Preamble is not a part of the Constitution.
2. In the Kesavananda Bharati case (1973) the Court held that it is a part of the Constitution.
3. It has been amended once, by the 42nd Amendment.
4. It is enforceable in a court of law.
Which of the above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 3 only

B. 1 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. The Preamble is non-justiciable, so 4 is wrong.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (word in the Preamble) with List-II (meaning):

List-I (word in the Preamble)	List-II (meaning)
A. Sovereign	**1.** No official State religion
B. Secular	**2.** Head of State is elected
C. Republic	**3.** Free from external control
D. Socialist	**4.** Democratic socialism with a mixed economy

(1) A → 3 B → 1 C → 2 D → 4

(2) A → 3 B → 2 C → 1 D → 4

(3) A → 1 B → 3 C → 2 D → 4

(4) A → 3 B → 1 C → 4 D → 2

Answer: (1) Sovereign: freedom from outside control; Secular: no State religion; Republic: elected head; Socialist: democratic socialism.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements about the Preamble is NOT correct?

A. It declares India to be a sovereign, socialist, secular, democratic republic.

B. The words 'unity and integrity of the nation' were added in 1976.

C. It is the source of the legislature's power to make laws.

D. 'We, the people of India' shows that sovereignty rests with the people.

Answer: C. The Preamble is neither a source of power nor a limit on the legislature's power.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): The Preamble of the Constitution can be amended by Parliament.
Reason (R): The Supreme Court held that the Preamble is a part of the Constitution, but the basic structure cannot be destroyed.
Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: A. Being part of the Constitution, it can be amended (as in 1976) within the basic structure limit.

PRACTICE

A State government orders that one particular religion's rituals will be compulsory in all government schools. Which ideal of the Preamble does this order most directly go against?

A. Secular

B. Sovereign

C. Republic

D. Socialist

Answer: A. A secular State treats all faiths equally and has no official religion.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write the Preamble's key words with one meaning each. 2. Write the two cases (Berubari, Kesavananda) and the verdict of each. 3. Which words were added in 1976 and by which amendment?

REASONING · Coding–decoding

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? A word, number or message is changed into a secret form by a hidden rule. You must find the rule and apply it to a new word. Use the **letter positions (A=1 … Z=26)** from Day 2. Typical types: **letter shifting**, **opposite (reverse) letters**, **changing shift**, **number coding**, **substitution (word changed with another word)** and **group codes** (find a word's code by comparing sentences).

Type	Example	Method and answer
Same shift	CAT → ECV; DOG → ?	Each letter +2: D→F, O→Q, G→I: **FQI**
Opposite letters	TABLE → GZYOV; CHAIR → ?	Opposite = 27 − position: C→X, H→S, A→Z, I→R, R→I: **XSZRI**
Changing shift	FRIEND → HUMJTK; CANDLE → ?	Shifts +2, +3, +4, +5, +6, +7: C→E, A→D, N→R, D→I, L→R, E→L: **EDRIRL**
Number coding	A=2, B=4, C=6 … (twice the position). Value of FACE?	F=12, A=2, C=6, E=10: **30**
Substitution	If red is called blue, blue is green, green is yellow: colour of the sky?	The sky is really blue; blue is called green: **green**. Always start from the real object.
Group code	'sun moon star' = ka mi zo; 'moon sky cloud' = zo ta pe. Code for 'moon'?	The common word moon ↔ common code **zo**

EXAMPLE

Steps: (1) Write positions above both words. (2) Find the change letter by letter (+, −, 27 − x). (3) If the change differs, look for a pattern in the changes. (4) Apply to the new word and **check by decoding one letter back**.

EXAM TRAP

In **group codes**, only the word and code that appear **in both sentences** can be matched first. In **opposite-letter** codes, positions add to **27**. In **substitution**, answer using the **new name** for the real thing.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

If in a certain code CAT is written as ECV, how will DOG be written in that code?

A. FQI

B. FPI

C. EPI

D. FQH

Answer: A. Each letter is shifted +2: D→F, O→Q, G→I.

PRACTICE

If TABLE is written as GZYOV in a certain code, how will CHAIR be written?

A. XSZRI

B. XSZIR

C. WSZRI

D. XTZRI

Answer: A. Opposite letters (27 − position): C→X, H→S, A→Z, I→R, R→I.

PRACTICE

If FRIEND is coded as HUMJTK, how will CANDLE be coded?

A. EDRIRL

B. EDRIRK

C. DERIRL

D. EDSIRL

Answer: A. Shifts are +2, +3, +4, +5, +6, +7: C→E, A→D, N→R, D→I, L→R, E→L.

PRACTICE

In a code language, 'sun moon star' is written 'ka mi zo', 'moon sky cloud' is written 'zo ta pe', and 'star cloud rain' is written 'mi pe da'. What is the code for 'sun'?

A. ka

B. mi

C. zo

D. ta

Answer: A. 'moon' is common to sentences 1 and 2, so moon = zo. 'star' is common to 1 and 3, so star = mi. The remaining code in sentence 1 is ka for sun.

PRACTICE

If red is called blue, blue is called green, green is called yellow, yellow is called white and white is called black, what is the colour of the sky?

A. Blue

B. Green

C. Yellow

D. White

Answer: B. The sky is blue, and blue is called green.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write the six coding types with one example each. 2. Why must you start from the real object in substitution questions? 3. Make your own opposite-letter code for your name.

NOTEBOOK PAGE · Day 3: write this from memory

Close the notes. Write these headings, fill every blank, then correct in a different colour.

HISTORY: Why new religions? Politics · Society · Economy · Religion

Area	Write
Politics	16 Mahajanapadas (Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa, Avanti strongest; Assaka on the Godavari); Kshatriyas against Brahmin top place
Society	Rigid hereditary varna; Shudras and women low; birth vs conduct
Economy	Iron plough, cattle needed, towns, trade, punch-marked coins, merchants rose
Religion	Costly rituals, animal sacrifice, Sanskrit, priests; people wanted a simple local-language path

	Buddhism	Jainism
Founder, life	Gautama, Shakya, Lumbini c. 563 BCE; left home at 29; enlightenment at 35 (Bodh Gaya); first sermon Sarnath; death Kushinagar c. 483 BCE	Mahavira, Jnatrika, Kundagrama c. 599 BCE; left home at 30; Kaivalya at 42 (Rijupalika); death Pavapuri c. 527 BCE
Teaching	4 Noble Truths, Eightfold Path, Middle Path, Panchasheela, anatta	Triratna, 5 vows, jiva, Anekantavada, Syadvada, no creator God
Canon, language, sects	Tripitaka, Pali; 4 Councils; Hinayana, Mahayana, Vajrayana	12 Angas, Prakrit; Councils Pataliputra and Valabhi; Digambara, Svetambara

Also write: 4 councils (Rajagriha–Ajatashatru, Vaishali–Kalashoka, Pataliputra–Ashoka, Kundalavana–Kanishka); AP sites: Amaravati, Nagarjunakonda, Salihundam, Bavikonda, Thotlakonda.

POLITY: The Preamble

- Write: We the People; Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic, Republic (one meaning each); J-L-E-F with sub-parts; adopted 26 Nov 1949.
- Cases: Berubari 1960 (not part); Kesavananda 1973 (part, basic structure); LIC 1995. Amended once: 42nd Amend. 1976 (Socialist, Secular, Integrity). Non-justiciable; not a source of power or a limit.

REASONING: Coding–decoding

Write the 6 types with one example each: same shift, opposite letters (27 − x), changing shift, number coding, substitution (start from the real object), group code (find the common word).